

Front-button pinafore dress

EU38 sewing guide . 5 pieces . 1.5 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Bodice Front - cut 2 (center front opening)

Bodice Back - cut 2

Skirt Front - cut 1 on fold

Skirt Back - cut 2 (center back seam)

Strips / notions (chalked on fabric, not printed)

Bias binding (neckline + armholes) - cut 1 strip(s) 1207 x 25 mm ON THE BIAS (45° to the grain), join end to end (total 1207 mm)

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope, underbust - sew a quick muslin (test version) from cheap fabric first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled: pieces marked 'on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice.
4. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
5. Sew all darts first, pressing toward the center.
6. Sew the bodice shoulder seams and press them open.
7. Prepare the neckline bias strip: join the ends as needed and press it in half lengthwise along the marked fold line.
8. Bind the neckline with the bias strip, right sides together and raw edges even, leaving the last 2 cm free at each center back edge (the zipper goes there later). Ease the strip gently around the curves. Trim to 6 mm, turn the folded edge to the inside and topstitch or slipstitch it down.
9. Sew the bodice side seams.
10. Finish each armhole the same way with its bias strip: press it in half, bind the armhole right sides together, ease around the curve, then turn and topstitch it to the inside.
11. Sew the skirt seams (leave the center back seam open where the zipper will go), then join bodice to skirt at the waist seam, matching side seams.
12. Insert an invisible zipper in the center back through bodice and skirt: install the zipper BEFORE closing the seam below it, then close the rest of the seam.
13. Fold the free binding ends back over the zipper tape and hand-tack them down so the edge sits clean against the zipper.
14. Try it on, then hem with a 2 cm double fold.

15. Front placket: the front now OPENS at the center front cut it as TWO mirror-image fronts (cut 2), NOT on the fold, because the buttons open the garment. Each front carries an 18 mm grown-on button stand past the center front (marked fold line at CF, fold-back facing line inside). Interface the stand. Mark the buttonholes on the RIGHT front one is placed at the bust level to stop gaping and the buttons on the LEFT front on the center-front line (women's fronts lap right over left). Cut horizontal buttonholes starting 3 mm past the center front toward the edge, 21 mm long. Change the button size to suit and re-space if needed.